

Week 1 Logic Lab

PARSING ARGUMENTS IN FRESH CASES

Purpose: Use Whately's four-step test on **new** examples. For each argument below, work with: **Conclusion** (what is being claimed), **Stated reason** (what support is actually given), **Hidden assumption** (what unstated idea must be true for the reason to prove the conclusion), and **Follows** (does the conclusion actually follow?). Do not copy examples from the reading handout; reason about the sentences given here.

Part 1: Name the Claim and the Reason

Part 1 Q1: "Our team has won its last three games, so we will definitely win the championship." State the **conclusion** and the **stated reason** in your own words.

Part 1 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 1 Q2: "She apologized in a sincere tone, so she must truly regret what she did." State the **conclusion** and the **stated reason** in your own words.

Part 1 Q2 ANSWER BOX

Part 2: Full Four-Step Test

Part 2 Q1: “This study app has been downloaded five million times, so it must be the best tool for learning chemistry.” Identify the conclusion, stated reason, hidden assumption, and whether the conclusion follows.

Part 2 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 2 Q2: “The weather report predicts rain on Saturday, so we should call off Friday night’s outdoor concert.” Identify the conclusion, stated reason, hidden assumption, and whether the conclusion follows.

Part 2 Q2 ANSWER BOX

Part 3: Trickier Everyday Arguments

Part 3 Q1: “Every member of the student council voted for this proposal, so the proposal must be fair.” Identify the conclusion, stated reason, hidden assumption, and whether the conclusion follows.

Part 3 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 3 Q2: “No one in this debate club has read more sources than Jordan, so Jordan’s conclusion must be correct.” Identify the conclusion, stated reason, hidden assumption, and whether the conclusion follows.

Part 3 Q2 ANSWER BOX

Part 4: Build and Diagnose

Part 4 Q1: Write one short original argument (two or three sentences) about a school rule, a team decision, a local policy, or a disagreement you have seen. Then analyze **your own** argument with the full four-step test. Label your answer: **Conclusion**, **Stated reason**, **Hidden assumption**, and **Follows**.

Part 4 Q1 ANSWER BOX